

that we record ESG and carbon emissions data in our system so that you have actual data. And that's exactly what Indian companies are also asking for.

Q: SAP caters to 26 industries globally. Which are the key industries for SAP in India?

A: Right now, when you look at where there is high need for technology in India, it's car manufacturers that are moving to electric vehicles. Green energy transition in India is super important. And technology plays a key role in manufacturing. When I was in India, we talked about the commerce platform you are going to build for SMEs to offer their products and services digitally. We also see a huge demand for technology in retail. So, these are a few key industries that just come to mind. But there will probably be a great example for every industry.

Q: Are SAP solutions relevant for Indian farmers, given the impact of climate change?

A: First, kudos to your PM. He talked a lot about digital, and wants the public sector to be the front-runner. And his second focus was about wanting India to be more sustainable and be a front-runner in decarbonisation. With regard to farming, he said, 'How can we make sure that from the big companies down to the farmers, we have transparency around what is the most sustainable way to grow and produce certain goods? And how can technology help us reduce carbon emissions?' So, we also want to make sure that the big companies can source and help the farmers produce in a more sustainable way. The whole value chain down to the farmers should not only be transparent, but with that transparency must come awareness and the need for action, to help all farmers produce goods in a more sustainable way. And yes, that was a big topic with your government.

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“India has some 60 million SMEs. That's like almost all the people living in Germany! And all of these companies [are] looking at tech to succeed in the market. It's not like we need to convince them; now they come and tell us, 'Hey, we want to have SAP helping us to grow our business'”

